

Ignition Barriers for Spray Foam

Building codes require an approved ignition barrier over exposed spray foam in most attics and crawl spaces. Here's what it is, why it matters, and how we handle it correctly.

15-Min

TYPICAL IGNITION BARRIER RATING

Code-Required

IRC / IBC IN MOST ATTICS & CRAWLSPACES

Multiple Options

COATINGS, BOARDS & FACINGS

KEY BENEFITS



Code Compliance

Most residential and commercial codes require an ignition barrier over exposed foam in attics and crawl spaces unless the foam is specifically tested and approved for open use.



Protects Your Investment

Passing inspection the first time avoids costly rework, project delays, and potential issues at resale or refinance.



Applied by Trained Crews

Correct coverage, thickness, and cure time all matter. Our crews apply ignition barriers to manufacturer and code specifications.



Delays Ignition

An ignition barrier is designed to delay the time it takes for foam to reach ignition temperature if exposed to a flame source, giving occupants more time to react.



Multiple Approved Options

Intumescent coatings, thermal barrier paints, rigid facings, and certain foam products with built-in ratings can all satisfy the requirement depending on the application.



Inspection-Ready Documentation

We can provide product data sheets and application records to support your permit inspection.



WHERE IT'S TYPICALLY REQUIRED

- Attics with foam left exposed (no drywall)
- Crawl spaces with exposed foam walls
- Unfinished basements per local code
- Any space without a code-approved covering



IGNITION BARRIER VS. THERMAL BARRIER

An ignition barrier (e.g., 15-minute rated coating) is typically allowed in attics and crawl spaces. A thermal barrier (such as 1/2" drywall, 15-minute rated) is required in most living spaces where foam is exposed to the interior. We identify which applies to each area of your project.

Ignition Barriers for Spray Foam

GREEN IDEA INSULATION



15-Min

TYPICAL IGNITION
BARRIER RATING



Code-Required

IRC / IBC IN MOST
ATTICS & CRAWLSPACES



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COATINGS, BOARDS
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Crawl spaces
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Any space without
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**IGNITION
BARRIER**

**THERMAL
BARRIER**



VS.

15-MINUTE RATED
COATING / PAINT

15-MINUTE RATED
(E.G., 1/2" DRYWALL)



Requirements vary by jurisdiction and product listing;
we confirm the applicable code for your project.



Contact us today
for a free, no-obligation quote.



GREEN IDEA
— INSULATION —